

Nigeria 2027 Presidential Candidate

Evaluation Framework: Seyi Makinde

This document outlines key research domains and specific items investigated for Governor Seyi Makinde, assessing his viability as a declared presidential contender for the 2027 general elections.

1. Background & Verified Record

Personal & Professional History

Oluseyi Abiodun Makinde was born on December 25, 1967, in Ibadan, Oyo State, to Pa Olatubosun Makinde (a teacher-turned-accountant) and Abigail Makinde. He began his education at St. Paul Primary School and completed his primary schooling at St. Michael Primary School, Yemetu, Ibadan. He proceeded to Bishop Phillips Academy, Monatan, Ibadan, for his secondary education. In 1985, he gained admission to the University of Lagos (UNILAG), where he graduated with a Bachelor of Science (Hons) degree in Electrical Engineering in 1990. Makinde has undertaken extensive specialized professional and executive training globally:

- In 1998, he trained at Industrial Control Services in Houston, Texas, on Safety Shutdown Systems.
- In 1999, he studied the Development of Analytical Competence for Managing Operations at the Lagos Business School.
- In 2000, he completed advanced training in industrial automation.
- In 2002, he studied the Fundamentals of Crude Sampling at the Jiskoot Auto Control Training Centre in Kent, England.
- In 2005, he studied Understanding and Solving Complex Business Problems at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) Sloan School of Management.

His corporate career began during his compulsory National Youth Service Corps (NYSC) deployment to the Shell Petroleum Development Company (SPDC) of Nigeria (1990–1992), where he was engaged as a pupil engineer. From 1992 to 1997, he worked as a field engineer (Eket operations) and was promoted to Field Manager in 1995 at Rebold International Limited. In 1997, at the age of 29, Makinde founded his first private enterprise, Makon Engineering and Technical Services Limited (METS). METS subsequently evolved into the Makon Group, an international oil and gas, power generation, and engineering conglomerate. He is a Fellow of the Nigerian Society of Engineers (NSE) and holds memberships in the Council for Regulations of Engineering in Nigeria (COREN), the International Society of Automation (ISA), and the Institute of Measurement and Control UK.

Regarding his integrity and financial disclosure record:

- **The 2019 Asset Declaration:** Upon assuming the governorship in May 2019, Makinde publicly declared his assets (Form OYSE/2019/001). He disclosed a net worth of over N48 billion (specifically N48,150,736,889) in corporate equity and assets. His cash assets

included N234,742,296.01 and \$30,056.99, alongside Eurobonds valued at \$3,793,500 and other securities worth N120,500,000. The linked companies included METS, Energy Traders and Technical Services (ETTS) Limited, Makon Oil and Gas, Makon Group, Makon Construction, and Makon Power System, with N3.389 billion in existing corporate loan notes. He also committed to donating his entire gubernatorial salary to the Oyo State Teacher's Pension Fund.

- **The 2023 Asset Declaration:** At the end of his first term in May 2023, Makinde declared that his personal assets had depreciated by 10% to 12% due to his inability to actively oversee his private companies while running the affairs of Oyo State.
- **The 2026 Bodija Relief Fund Investigation:** In January 2026, the Human and Environmental Development Agenda (HEDA) submitted a formal petition to the EFCC under Chairman Olanipekun Olukoyede. The petition alleges the "diversion, misapplication, and criminal breach of trust" of N30 billion in Federal Government intervention funds released to the Oyo State Government following the January 16, 2024, illegal mining explosives blast in Bodija, Ibadan. Out of the N30 billion released, HEDA noted that only N4.5 billion was reportedly applied to victim compensation and emergency relief, with the remaining funds held in interest-bearing accounts in a commercial bank. Oyo State Information Commissioner Dotun Oyelade defended the administration, stating the N30 billion remains "untouched" until the balance of a projected N20 billion is received, claiming the petition is a politically motivated attempt to distract the governor ahead of the 2027 elections.

Public Service Track Record

Seyi Makinde's early political attempts were unsuccessful, including an ANPP bid for the Oyo South Senatorial seat in 2007 (lost to PDP's Kamoru Adedibu) and an SDP bid for the Oyo State Governorship in 2015. He successfully won the governorship in 2019 on the platform of the PDP, defeating the APC, and secured re-election in 2023.

Key regional and national administrative reforms implemented during his tenure include:

- Securing **sole ownership of the Ladoke Akintola University of Technology (LAUTECH)** for Oyo State, ending a multi-decade joint-ownership funding conflict with Osun State.
- Spearheading the creation, funding, and operationalization of the **Western Nigeria Security Network (Amotekun)** as a regional security initiative.
- Domesticating the anti-corruption fight by enacting the **Oyo State Financial Crimes Commission Act**, making Oyo one of the first states to create a localized equivalent to the EFCC.

2. Performance-Based Evaluation

Records of Actual Results

- **Economic Performance and Revenue Growth:** According to sub-national fiscal reports, Oyo State's total revenue grew from N115.33 billion in 2020 to N494.39 billion in

2024. In 2024, this comprised N408.74 billion in Gross FAAC allocations and N65.29 billion in Internally Generated Revenue (IGR). This represents a significant expansion from the N38.04 billion IGR recorded in 2020. In July 2025, Budget Commissioner Prof. Musibau Babatunde reported that the state achieved an 80% half-year revenue performance. On December 22, 2025, Makinde signed the state's **N892 billion 2026 "Budget of Production"** into law. The budget allocates N281.08 billion to recurrent expenditure (46.4% of the total budget size) to sustain the minimum wage, and N342.42 billion to capital expenditure.

- **National Minimum Wage and Labor Relations:** In December 2024, Governor Makinde approved a new **N80,000 national minimum wage** for the Oyo State civil service, exceeding the federal baseline of N70,000. Under the agreement reached with the Nigeria Labour Congress (NLC) and Trade Union Congress (TUC), the wage scale took nominal effect from July 1, 2024, with financial implementation beginning on January 1, 2025. While celebrated by labor leaders, the Campaign for Democratic and Workers' Rights (CDWR) criticized the arrangement as a "Greek gift," noting that the financial delay to January 2025 meant workers lost several months of retroactive arrears, while state-owned tertiary institutions simultaneously hiked student tuition fees.
- **Infrastructure Delivery:** Under his "Omituntun" roadmaps, Makinde prioritized major transport corridors. He initiated the 110-kilometer Senator Rashidi Ladoja Circular Road in Ibadan, flagging off the 32.2 km South-East wing in March 2024. In January 2024, the Oyo State House of Assembly approved a N150 billion loan from Afreximbank and Access Bank specifically to accelerate the completion of this circular road. On November 12, 2025, the administration commissioned the Iwo Road Central Bus Terminals 1 & 2, completing all four modern transit hubs across Ibadan (Challenge, Ojoo, New Ife Road, and Iwo Road).
- **Energy and Independent Power:** To combat persistent national grid collapses, Makinde partnered with Elektron Energy to execute an **11MW hybrid Independent Power Project (IPP)** on a Build-Operate-Transfer basis at a cost of N8,027,430,214. The plant (comprising 10MW gas-fired and 1MW PV solar) is supplied by the Shell Gas Pipeline project. Phase 1 (5MW) was completed and commissioned on December 6, 2024, powering the State Secretariat, the House of Assembly, judicial complexes, and 12 major healthcare facilities.
- **Security Outcomes:** Makinde operationalized the Western Nigeria Security Network Agency (Amotekun) in November 2020, appointing Sikiru Kayode Akande as Board Chairman. Between June 2021 and May 2023, Amotekun conducted 10 successful kidnapping rescues. However, severe security challenges persist: in May 2026, suspected terrorists riding motorcycles launched a lethal raid in Oriire Local Government Area. Gunmen abducted seven teachers and pupils from Community High School, Esiele. The abductors subsequently murdered a mathematics teacher in captivity. The rescue operation suffered a major setback when a tactical team of soldiers and Amotekun corps members ran into Improvised Explosive Devices (IEDs) planted by the abductors, resulting in multiple casualties.
- **Education & Health Metrics:** The administration abolished the N3,000 education levy in

public schools, approved the recruitment of 14,000 primary and secondary school teachers, and completed the upgrade of 264 primary healthcare centres across Oyo's 33 LGAs.

- **Agribusiness and Food Security:** Makinde established the Oyo State Agribusiness Development Agency (OYSADA), hiring Debo Akande from IITA to lead it. The agency successfully transformed the moribund 1960s Fashola farm settlement into a modern Agribusiness Industrial Hub. The project attracted international attention, including a high-profile visit from Sierra Leone President Julius Maada Bio in early 2025/2026.

Crisis Leadership

During the 2021 Shasha market inter-ethnic clashes, Makinde de-escalated rural violence by working closely with a delegation of Northern governors (including Atiku Bagudu and Abdullahi Ganduje). He successfully demonstrated that the clashes stemmed from a localized market leadership dispute rather than a systematic tribal war, restoring commercial activity to the market. However, his handling of the January 2024 Bodija explosion has faced significant accountability challenges due to the N30 billion federal relief funds being kept in commercial bank accounts.

3. Institutional Context & Constraints

Systemic Factors

- **Federal vs. State Power Dynamics:** Makinde is a fierce defender of sub-national fiscal independence. Following the July 11, 2024, Supreme Court ruling that outlawed Joint State-Local Government accounts and granted financial autonomy to the 774 Local Government Councils, Makinde publicly dismissed the verdict as a "mere distraction". He claimed a "lacuna" had been created between the court's decision and the 1999 Constitution. He convened an emergency consultative meeting of Oyo stakeholders and set up legal and technical committees, successfully delaying the direct FAAC implementation in Oyo State for 90 days.
- **Traditional Institutions and Royalty:** Makinde's relationships with high-ranking traditional rulers have been highly volatile. His attempt to reform the Oyo State Council of Obas and Chiefs by establishing a rotational chairmanship system drew strong public opposition from the late Alaafin of Oyo, who countered the governor's claim of mutual consensus. More recently, royal protocols collapsed at state functions: at the coronation of Oba Rashidi Ladoja as the Olubadan, a widely shared video showed the current Alaafin of Oyo, Oba Akeem Owode, being snubbed by other traditional rulers, highlighting deep-seated structural friction within Oyo's traditional hierarchy.
- **Party Cohesion and Cabinet Appointments:** Makinde's governance philosophy of being "blind to party colouration" has led him to appoint multiple technocrats and political figures with ties to the opposition APC. While this has broadened his administrative capacity, it has triggered severe internal friction within the Oyo State PDP, with critics accusing him of diluting the party's ideological base to secure cross-party alliances for

his 2027 bid.

Constraints on Implementation

- **The Debt Sustainability Challenge:** According to the Oyo State Medium-Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF 2024–2026), the state's domestic debt-to-IGR ratio reached **319.72%**, far exceeding the sustainable threshold of 150%. Total sub-national debt escalated from N123.5 billion in 2018 to N193.68 billion by 2022. However, according to the Debt Management Office (DMO), Oyo's domestic debt stood at N77.41 billion as of December 31, 2025. While Fitch Ratings affirmed Oyo State's Long-Term Issuer Default Rating (IDR) at 'B-' with a Positive Outlook in November 2024, the state remains highly vulnerable to commodity price swings due to its structural reliance on federal transfers.

4. Political Funding & Incentive Networks

Campaign Finance

Makinde's multi-decade success with the Makon Group—valued at over N48 billion in personal equity—positions him as one of the wealthiest self-funded politicians in Nigeria. This financial self-reliance insulates him from traditional "godfather" networks, allowing him to maintain independent political maneuvers that are unavailable to candidates who rely on corporate donors or state-caputred patronage systems.

Power Brokers & Alliances

- **The PDP-APM "Reset Nigeria" Alliance:** At a mega rally held at the historic Mapo Hall in Ibadan, Makinde formally declared his 2027 presidential ambition under the banner of the **"Reset Nigeria Movement"**. He announced a grand coalition between a major faction of the PDP and the Allied Peoples' Movement (APM) to counter the risk of Nigeria transitioning into a one-party state under the APC.
- **The Wike Feud:** Makinde has completely broken off his G-5 alliance with FCT Minister Nyesom Wike. In a major political confrontation, Makinde declared that any member of the PDP who remains aligned with Wike is an "enemy of progress".
- **Northern Outreach and Third-Force Realignment:** To build a national coalition, Makinde joined Peter Obi and Senator Seriake Dickson during Sallah festivities in Kano to meet with Rabiu Kwankwaso and the Kwankwassiya movement. This high-profile meeting has fueled speculation of a potential mega-merger under the African Democratic Congress (ADC) or a similar alternative platform.
- **Local Opposition Dynamics:** Despite his regional popularity, Makinde faces a coordinated APC-aligned pushback in his South-West base. Traditional Ibadan chiefs have publicly declared support for President Bola Ahmed Tinubu's second term, claiming Tinubu has "no rival" in the South-West, which presents a significant barrier to Makinde's regional consolidation.

5. Leadership Style & Psychology

Decision-Making Traits

Makinde is a technocratic, pragmatic, and highly strategic actor. He heavily relies on data-driven, economic solutions rather than populist "political solutions" (as seen in his agribusiness and IPP structures). He possesses an exceptionally high risk tolerance, demonstrated by his early 2027 presidential declaration, his defiance of the federal local government financial autonomy directive, and his willingness to sever ties with former G-5 allies.

Communication & Public Interaction

He communicates with a highly confident and assertive tone. However, his rhetoric has drawn sharp criticism: in April 2026, during an opposition meeting in Ibadan, Makinde made a direct reference to the violent "**Operation Wetie**" saga of the old Western Region First Republic. APC National Secretary Ajibola Basiru condemned the remark as "inciting and irresponsible," accusing the governor of trying to trigger regional instability.

6. Policy Feasibility & Economic Modeling

Policy Specifics

Makinde's policy blueprint for Nigeria centers on:

- 1. **Agribusiness Industrialization:** Replicating the OYSADA/Fashola model nationwide to achieve food security and reduce capital flight from food imports.
- 2. **Decentralized Energy Infrastructure:** Leveraging sub-national powers to build independent power plants (similar to the 11MW Elektron IPP) to bypass the failing national grid.
- 3. **Regional Connectivity:** Building massive transport and logistics networks through public-private partnerships.

Economic Forecasting

While his Oyo state administration achieved solid revenue growth and a high budget performance (80% in 2025), scaling this nationwide faces severe structural headwinds. The Oyo State debt profile remains a key vulnerability, with domestic-debt-to-IGR ratios far exceeding sustainable levels. Additionally, implementing a national wage of N80,000 without corresponding increases in economic productivity risks driving up inflation and fiscal deficits for other sub-national states that lack Oyo's agrarian and corporate tax base.

7. Comparative Indicators

Indicator	Seyi Makinde (PDP/APM - Declared)	Bola Ahmed Tinubu (APC - Incumbent)	Opposition Counterparts (Atiku / Peter Obi)

Background legitimacy	High (Corporate engineering success, transparent asset declaration)	Low-Moderate (US drug forfeiture ¹ , CSU certificate deposition ²)	Mixed (Varies by candidate ³)
Economic outcomes	Moderate-High (Doubled state IGR, Fitch B- Positive outlook, 11MW IPP)	Mixed (S&P upgrade ⁴ , but 140m multi-dimensionally poor ⁵)	N/A (Not currently in executive office)
Security performance	Moderate (Amotekun operational, but fatal rural abductions persist)	Low-Moderate (Terrorism GTI 6th rank ⁶ , rural abductions ⁷)	N/A
Policy realism	High (Agribusiness, localized PPP infrastructure)	Moderate (Ambitious macro targets ⁸ facing severe debt servicing ⁹)	Moderate (Theoretical frameworks)
Institutional support likelihood	Moderate-High (Strong South-West base, PDP/APM grand alliance)	Very High (Incumbent advantage, APC machinery control under Yilwatda ¹⁰)	Low (Highly fragmented and competing interests ¹¹)
Integrity score	Moderate (Asset declarations offset by N30bn EFCC petition)	Low (Historical US forfeiture ¹ , controversial Chagoury network ties ¹³)	Mixed
Leadership temperament	Pragmatic, Technocratic, Assertive, Provocative	Ruthless, Strategic, Pragmatic	Varies

8. Sources & Validation

- **Background, Education & Career:** UNILAG graduation records (1990); MIT executive education; Corporate Affairs Commission METS/Makon Group incorporation records.
- **Asset Declarations & Liquid Wealth:** Code of Conduct Bureau asset declarations 2019 (Form OYSE/2019/001) and end-of-tenure submission (May 2023).
- **Oyo State Revenue, Budgets & MTEF:** BudgIT State of States Report 2025; Oyo State Ministry of Budget and Economic Planning 2020-2024 Revenue Sheets; signed 2026 Appropriation Bill.
- **HEDA EFCC Relief Fund Investigation:** HEDA Resource Centre Petition (dated January 5, 2026) addressed to EFCC Chairman Olanipekun Olukoyede; Oyo Ministry of Information statements.
- **Local Government Autonomy Dispute:** Supreme Court Judgment SC/CV/343/2024 ¹⁴; Oyo State technical committee reports; Makinde public address on FAAC direct remittance suspension.

- **Minimum Wage Agreements:** National Minimum Wage Amendment Act 2024 ¹⁵; Oyo State Government/Organized Labor Joint Communiqué (December 2024); CDWR press releases.
- **IPP and Infrastructure Projects:** Elektron Energy project agreements; Oyo Ministry of Public Works road briefs; Rashidi Ladoja Circular Road South-East wing flag-off transcripts.
- **Amotekun & Oriire LGA Attacks:** Western Nigeria Security Network operational sheets; Oyo State Police Command report on the May 2026 Oriire High School abductions.
- **2027 Realignment & Reset Alliance:** Mapo Hall speech transcripts; PDP National Secretariat updates; Kano Sallah meeting details.
- **Operation Wetie Controversy:** Transcripts of the Ibadan opposition summit; APC National Secretariat statements.

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<https://statehouse.gov.ng/apc-elects-yilwatda-as-new-chairman-as-president-tinubu-urges-governors-to-deepen-grassroots-engagement/>

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